

At Galgotias University's School of Media and Communication Studies, students don't just study the media, they step right into it. If the institute has an environment that encourages creativity, curiosity and confidence in students, it also has a strong industry connect so they get hands-on training. Students regularly visit media houses, attend workshops and interact with journalists, filmmakers and advertising experts to understand how the industry works and what it expects from them.

With state-of-the-art infrastructure, students step into studios that feel like real newsrooms—complete with cameras, lights, a production control room, and even a chroma key set. Whether shooting a news bulletin or recording a talk show, they get to do it all as part of their regular training. There is also a podcast lab, called PlugIn Podcast by Galgotias University, where students create and publish their own shows. This builds confidence in public speaking, scripting and digital storytelling—skills that are increasingly becoming essential in today's media world. Another key feature is the Graphics Lab, which trains students in design, editing and visual effects.

The institute offers degree programmes, including BA (Hons) in Journalism and Mass Communication and MA in Journalism and Mass Communication, which include specialisations in journalism, entertainment and strategic communication, advertising and corporate communication and film and television production. "Students are trained to work across platforms and are encouraged to engage in creative and critical thinking, content production, campaign development and research," says Prof. Avadesh Kumar, pro vice-chancellor of the university.

AI has become a major part of the media workflow. To help students keep pace with this transformation, the school has set up a dedicated AI Lab where they learn to create virtual anchors for news bulletins and use automation in video editing and content scheduling. These are not just experiments; they are the future of journalism, filmmaking and digital content. "It might sound futuristic, but they are already learning how to work alongside such technology—by writing sharper scripts, fact-checking faster and focusing more on creativity, while AI handles repetitive tasks," says Prof. A. Ram Pandey, dean, School of Media and Communication Studies.

The faculty also regularly updates course content to reflect these trends; they conduct special workshops, guest lectures and tech demonstrations. The school has signed an academic partnership with Nanyang Technological University, Singapore, to foster joint research and student exchange activities.

Student-led initiatives have also seen a boost in recent years with the launch of GNN (Galgotias News Network)—a news platform where young journalists and content creators cover campus stories, host live shows and produce weekly bulletins.

Over the past five years, the school has transformed itself into one of the most dynamic and future-ready media schools in the country. It has adopted project-based learning (PBL) across courses, which has made learning more engaging and outcomes more tangible. Even the shift from memory-based exams to skill and performance-based assessments has changed the learning experience. Students are now evaluated on what they can create, produce, write and present. ■

GURUSPEAK



"At SMCS, students aren't just trained for jobs. They are prepared to tell stories that matter, ask tough questions and create content that connects with people"

PROF. A. RAM PANDEY
Dean, School of Media and Communication Studies

STUDENTSPEAK



"Smart classrooms make learning fun, interactive and engaging. They help us understand convoluted topics better with the help of real-life simulations, and the use of artificial intelligence teaches us how to solve problems better"

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